



WINCHESTER MODEL 1876



WINCHESTER MODEL 1894

**1860** The Henry rifle, designed by Benjamin Henry, is made by the New Haven Arms Company, under Oliver Winchester and John M. Davies.

**1866** After the reorganization of the company as the Winchester Repeating Arms Company, the Winchester Model 1866 is launched.

**1873** Winchester's first center-fire cartridge is used in the successful Model 1873.

**1876** To celebrate the US Centennial, Winchester introduces the Model 1876, designed to take full-powered center-fire cartridges.

**1883** Winchester begins to work in partnership with firearms designer John Browning.

**1894** The Model 1894 is launched; it will eventually become one of the best-selling hunting rifles of all time.

**1903** The company begins to produce the first of a series of self-loading rifles.

**1914** Winchester produces firearms for the British government during World War I, including the Pattern 1914 Enfield rifle.

**1931** After suffering poor sales during the postwar period and the Great Depression, the company goes into receivership.

siege of Plevna. They were outnumbered four to one but inflicted huge losses on the Russians because of the superior firepower of their Winchesters. Many European armies adopted repeating rifles in the years following the Russo-Turkish War.

### ONE IN A THOUSAND

Further improvements to the line followed, including the Model 1873 and the Model 1876 (see p. 117), the first Winchester rifle to be specially designed to fire full-powered

center-fire cartridges for superior stopping power. It was the Model 1873 that made Winchester firearms especially popular in the American West, both for hunting and defense. Hunters found that they could bring down a buffalo at 200 yards (180m), and with a weapon as powerful as this they also believed that they

### ► WINCHESTER '73

James Stewart holds a Winchester rifle in the film *Winchester '73*. The movie in part tells the story of what happens when a "One in a thousand" Winchester passes from one owner to another.

could protect themselves and their families in the tough and dangerous frontier country. The Model 1873 also heralded an ingenious marketing campaign that showcased the high quality of many of the company's products. From 1875, Winchester tested its rifle barrels during manufacturing and selected the most accurate to be equipped with set triggers and engraved with the legend "One in a thousand." These weapons were sold at a premium price of \$100 and were prized for their accuracy; they are still valued highly by collectors today.

To reinforce the link between Winchester products and the American West, the company introduced the slogan, "Winchester: the gun that won the West" from 1919. Many pioneers carried Winchester rifles and this phrase



certainly helped strengthen the link between Winchester and American history, underpinning the company's reputation as it continued to produce rifles, shotguns, and other firearms into the 20th century.

